

Page 1 of 6 · Bubbles by the Path

A rolling wave has scattered the lagoon stepping stones and separated a school of little fish. Cereal-Swimmer finds a trail of bubbles beside the first stone. Octo-Pop taps each bubble while they count the starting place on their watery number line.



Page 2 of 6 · A Hop Forward

Two fish peek from behind the next stepping stones and join the group already waiting. Cereal-Swimmer starts from the number they have reached and hops forward twice. Counting on saves the friends from beginning the whole bubble trail again.



Page 3 of 6 · The Hidden Stone

Another wave washes over the path and hides one numbered stone beneath foamy water. The stones on either side remain visible, so Octo-Pop holds the line steady while Cereal-Swimmer follows the forward sequence to identify the covered number.
Sequence: 2, 3, ?, 5



Page 4 of 6 · A School in a Tangle

The rescued fish follow arrows painted along the stones, but the school suddenly bunches into a silvery knot. Cereal-Swimmer checks which way each fish is facing. One swimmer is not following the forward direction and must turn to rejoin the line.

Read the seven fish from left to right. Fish 1, 2 and 3 face right. Fish 4 faces left. Fish 5, 6 and 7 face right. The arrows on the stones point right.



Page 5 of 6 · Spaces by the Gate

Seven fish reach the old lagoon gate, but its number line has more spaces to fill before it will open. Octo-Pop gathers the remaining swimmers while Cereal-Swimmer counts forward from seven to discover the missing part needed to reach ten.



Page 6 of 6 · The Last Number

The fish settle beside the restored stones, and the coral garden glows beyond the gate. One final space remains after seven, eight, nine. Cereal-Swimmer and Octo-Pop must name the number that completes the line and brings the whole school home.

Sequence: 7, 8, 9, ?

Questions for Cereal-Swimmer and the Number-Line Lagoon

Read the story together first. Use the page prompts and the questions after reading. Answers are below the dotted line: fold them under or cover them while reading.

Page 1 · Bubbles by the Path

Count the bubbles.

Choices: 4 · 5 · 6

Page 2 · A Hop Forward

Five and two more make how many?

Choices: 6 · 7 · 8

Page 3 · The Hidden Stone

Which number is missing?

Sequence: 2, 3, ?, 5 Choices: 3 · 4 · 6

Page 4 · A School in a Tangle

Which fish is out of order?

Read the seven fish from left to right. Fish 1, 2 and 3 face right. Fish 4 faces left. Fish 5, 6 and 7 face right. The arrows on the stones point right. Choices: Fish 2 · Fish 4 · Fish 6

Page 5 · Spaces by the Gate

Seven needs how many more to make ten?

Choices: 2 · 3 · 4

Page 6 · The Last Number

Which number finishes the line?

Sequence: 7, 8, 9, ? Choices: 9 · 10 · 11

After reading

How can you add two to five without starting again at one?

Answers (fold under before reading)

Page 1: 5. Five bubbles float by the first stone.

Page 2: 7. Five and two make seven.

Page 3: 4. Four belongs between three and five.

Page 4: Fish 4. The backward fish was breaking the direction pattern.

Page 5: 3. Seven and three make ten.

Page 6: 10. Ten completes the lagoon line.

After reading: Start at five and count two more steps: six, seven. The number line helps you keep your place.

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